San Diego, CA: white-collar jobs and employment

Prepared for Point Loma Nazarene University by NextChapter Research · career-site data as of 2026-10-22 · draft

Summary

The sample is 1,036 white-collar postings from 47 employers' own career sites. 17% are health care, 1% are entry-level, 45% are senior individual contributor or above, and median stated pay is $154,900 a year.

- **Labor market:** unemployment was 4.9% in 2026-08, against 5.1% a year earlier; nonfarm employment changed 0.7% over twelve months.
- **Entry-level:** 15 white-collar postings across 7 employers.
- **AI:** 33.4% of white-collar postings mention AI; those pay a median of $142,450 against $155,250 for the rest.
- **Concentration:** Sharp HealthCare alone is 16% of all postings, so the mix reflects the largest readable employers more than the whole market.

Coverage

1,247 postings in the area were read from 47 employers, and 1,036 of them are white-collar (83%). Another 131 could not be classified from the title and are left out. The frame is every white-collar job at every level, entry-level included (Census major groups 1 and 2).

Employers on career systems we cannot read are missing, so read these figures as describing the employers listed, not every opening in the area.

Large employers we looked for and could not read: UC San Diego Health, University of California San Diego, San Diego State University, University of San Diego, San Diego Community College District, Rady Children's Health, Kaiser Permanente, Qualcomm, General Atomics, Intuit, Jack in the Box, Sempra, San Diego Gas & Electric, Biogen.

Levels and functions

Level	Postings	Share
Entry	15	1%
Mid-level	559	54%
Senior individual contributor	206	20%
Manager	156	15%
Director	94	9%
VP and above	6	1%

Function	Postings	Entry-level	Employers	Median stated annual pay
Management, business and operations	208	1	28	$157,350
Technology and IT	184	6	16	$155,500
Healthcare practitioners	180	1	16	$130,946
Engineering and science	179	2	19	$149,787

Function	Postings	Entry-level	Employers	Median stated annual pay
Education and training	127	1	11	$171,000
Marketing, media and design	47	0	11	$182,750
Finance and accounting	42	1	13	$103,100
Legal	17	2	4	$235,736
Community and social service	17	0	6	$54,018
Supply chain and logistics	14	0	7	$111,692
Data and analytics	13	1	5	$157,350
HR and recruiting	8	0	6	$152,250

Employers, pay, AI and skills

Pay is stated in 82.0% of white-collar postings, with a median of $154,900 a year or $68.59 an hour.

Employer	All postings	White-collar	White-collar entry-level
Sharp HealthCare	195	129	1
Neurocrine Biosciences	116	112	0
Viasat, Inc.	107	103	0
Booz Allen Hamilton	108	97	4
Grossmont-Cuyamaca Community College District	87	87	0
Shield AI	80	78	1
Amazon	71	69	0
Illumina	57	52	0
Point Loma Nazarene University	54	49	0
Dexcom	49	45	0
Leidos	37	33	0
County of San Diego	48	28	4
Astrobotic	20	18	0
Abbott	14	13	0
Philips	14	13	2
US Bank	17	12	0
Humana	14	12	0
City of San Diego	31	10	2
Clark Construction	12	9	0
Cubic	10	9	1
PNC	12	6	0
Thermo Fisher	8	6	0

Employer	All postings	White-collar	White-collar entry-level
Thermo Fisher Scientific	8	6	0
JPMorgan Chase	10	5	0
Parsons	5	5	0
Cardinal Health	7	4	0
Palomar Health	12	3	0
Dick's Sporting Goods	9	3	0
Applied Medical	4	3	0
Sedgwick	5	2	0
Fifth Third	2	2	0
Natera	2	2	0
Zoll	2	2	0
iHeartMedia	3	1	0
Terminix	2	1	0
Smith & Nephew	1	1	0

AI. 346 postings (33.4%) mention AI or machine learning. They pay a median of $142,450 against $155,250 for the rest, 60% are senior individual contributor or above (37% for the rest), and 41% mention remote or hybrid work (8% for the rest).

Work arrangement and type. 14.0% mention remote work and 16.9% hybrid. 16.5% are part-time. 25.3% use contract, temporary, fractional or similar words, a W-2 and 1099 signal combined.

Posting age. 13.1% of postings with a posted date went up more than 90 days ago. Reposts and ghost-job risk need a second crawl.

Soft skill named	Share of white-collar postings
Communication	73%
Collaboration	69%
Leadership	57%
Problem solving	28%
Adaptability	25%
Named tools	25%
Creativity	5%
Empathy	1%

Entry-level openings, a sample

Employer	Role
County of San Diego	Certified Nurse Assistant-26461506
Cubic	Systems Engineering Execution Intern

Employer	Role
Shield AI	Summer 2027 - Software Engineer Intern
Booz Allen Hamilton	University - 2027 Summer Games Systems Engineer Intern - San Diego, CA
City of San Diego	Library Assistant II
$49,233.60 - $59,571.20 Annually	
Booz Allen Hamilton	University - 2027 Summer Games Data Scientist Intern - San Diego, CA
Sharp HealthCare	Pathologists' Assistant - Copley Lab - Day Shift - Per Diem
Philips	Intern – Systems Engineering (Sustaining & Design Controls) - San Diego, CA - Summer 2027
Philips	Intern - System Test Automation Engineer – San Diego, CA – Summer 2027
County of San Diego	Legal Support Assistant I-26278209
County of San Diego	Insect Detection Specialist I-Agriculture, Weights, and Measures-26540001AWM
City of San Diego	Finance Analyst I
$80,724.80 - $98,051.20 Annually	
Booz Allen Hamilton	University, 2027 Summer Games Cyber Security Intern - San Diego, CA
County of San Diego	Supervising Deputy County Counsel-Assessor/Recorder/County Clerk-26394609ARCC
Booz Allen Hamilton	University - 2027 Summer Games Software Developer Intern - San Diego, CA

Peer metros

Metro (BLS, 2026-08)	Unemployment rate	Year ago	Change (pts)	Nonfarm jobs (thousands)	12-month change
Riverside, CA	5.9%	6.2%	-0.3	1,712.2	+0.7%
Sacramento, CA	5.2%	5.4%	-0.2	1,109.3	+0.8%
San Diego, CA	4.9%	5.1%	-0.2	1,567.0	+0.7%
Phoenix, AZ	4.9%	4.3%	+0.6	2,463.8	+0.9%
Los Angeles, CA	4.8%	5.8%	-1.0	6,289.1	+0.6%
Seattle, WA	4.8%	4.8%	+0.0	2,143.9	+0.9%
San Francisco, CA	4.6%	4.9%	-0.3	2,427.2	+0.6%

BLS figures cover the whole metro. Posting comparisons use the same crawl and tagging in each metro but different employers, so read them as indicative.

Metro (career-site postings)	White-collar postings	Employers	Entry	Mid-level	Senior and above	Median annual pay	Mention AI
San Diego, CA	1,036	47	1%	54%	45%	$154,900	33.4%

Method and limits

- Source: employers' own career sites, crawled 2026-10-22, tagged by job title with fixed rules; titles that cannot be classified are excluded.
- AI, remote, hybrid and soft-skill figures are keyword matches in posting text; pay medians use only postings that state pay.

- Postings are not BLS job openings: one opening can have several postings and some are always open.
- There is no history yet. Functions gaining or losing, reposts and ghost-job risk need at least two crawls.
- Labor market data: BLS Local Area Unemployment Statistics and Current Employment Statistics bulk files, not seasonally adjusted.

Sources: employers' own career sites; U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics (LAUS, CES); O*NET. Figures describe the employers listed, not every opening in the area.